Damien GUESDON

CTO / HEAD OF AI INFRASTRUCTURE

Sovereign AI Architecture | OpenShift/Kubernetes Platforms | Critical Infrastructure

48 years old | Born 20/10/1977
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

CTO and infrastructure architect with 20 years of experience across critical environments, operator networks, bare-metal platforms and complex technical transformation. Former infrastructure CTO, I now specialize in sovereign AI platforms, AI industrialization on OpenShift/Kubernetes, secure RAG systems, tool orchestration and Zero Trust architectures. My focus is to design, structure and harden auditable, reproducible and secure AI platforms able to move from lab to production.

KEY SKILLS

AI Infrastructure & Platforms:
OpenShift, Kubernetes, Docker, RHEL/CentOS, bare metal, isolated and reproducible environments.

Sovereign AI Systems:
Local LLMs, secure RAG, vector databases, tool orchestration, controlled knowledge ingestion pipelines.

Architecture & Security:
Zero Trust, segmentation, high availability, auditability, DLP, flow control and platform hardening.

Platform Engineering:
Industrialization, environment standardization, operations, resilience, and PoC-to-production transition.

Technical Leadership:
Technical direction, architecture trade-offs, critical escalation management, team coordination and platform vision.

Communication:
Technical communication, strategic alignment, documentation, and executive/stakeholder engagement.

LANGUAGES

- French: Native
- English: Fluent (including technical)
- Catalan: In progress
- German: Basic

EDUCATION

Master of Science in AI Engineering, OpenClassrooms, 2026
Specialization: Data Science and Machine Learning Operations.

Higher Technical Diploma (BTS), IT Resource Mgmt, 2006
IT Resource Management Specialist

Higher Technical Diploma (BTS), Programming, 2003
Visual Basic, C++, PHP, HTML

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

AI Platform & OpenShift Architect – KISAI (Personal R&D)
Remote – Since June 2025

- **Platform design:** deployed and operated an OpenShift cluster on bare metal as a foundation for a sovereign AI platform.
- **AI systems:** integrated local models, secure RAG pipelines, vector search, AI building-block orchestration and isolated execution environments.
- **Architecture:** explored reproducible architecture patterns to move from experimentation to industrialization.
- **Foundational project:** progressively designed and implemented the SOPHIA architecture with a focus on security, sovereignty, auditability and resilience.

Chief Technology Officer (CTO) - Infrastructure – Alphalink
France – Jan 2024 – May 2025

- **Critical Incident Management:** Managed infra team and escalations Tier 3 support for strategic telecom accounts, ensuring SLAs were met during crises.
- **Strategic Roadmap:** Led technical quarterly business reviews (QBRs) to align infrastructure evolution with business needs.
- **Team Leadership:** Directed technical teams (18 people) focusing on operational excellence and network reliability.
- **Infrastructure Modernization:** MPLS core network evolution, cybersecurity strategy initialization, and compliance (ISO, GDPR).

Senior Infrastructure & Network Consultant – KISAI (Freelance)
France / Remote – 2018 – 2023

- **Critical Infrastructure:** Oversight of operator backbones, datacenters, and secure networks for various clients.
- **Strategic Consulting (CTO-as-a-Service):** Auditing existing architectures and recommending security and optimization strategies.
- **Project Management:** Leading complex migrations and digital transformation initiatives.

Technical Director / Senior Consultant – Auto-entrepreneur
La Plaine-sur-Mer – 2011 – 2018

- Deployed and managed operator backbone, datacenters, MPLS networks.
- Network engineering and ISP service integration.
- Project management for complex IT transformations.

Previous Experience
– 2005 – 2011

- **ALPHALINK** (2008-2011): Network Architect – Designed architectures, managed projects.
- **PYGRAM** (2007-08): Systems & Network Manager (VmWare, TSE).
- **Renault** (2007): Systems Administrator (1,900 workstations).
- **BI-SAM** (2006-07): UNIX Systems Administrator (AIX).
- **BNP Paribas** (2006): IT Specialist.